Moran Koren

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Game theory and mechanism design; information aggregation and social learning in markets; screening, gatekeeping and strategic self-selection; allocation under uncertainty (organ allocation, crowdfunding, housing for displaced populations); economics of AI and strategic machine learning; LLM-assisted and machine-verified economic theory.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2025– **Senior Lecturer, Department of Industrial Engineering and Management, Ben-Gurion University of the Negev**
Promoted; corresponds to early U.S. Associate Professor. Founder and PI, Game Theory and Agent Design Lab.

2025– **Member, Statistics & Data Analysis Program, Ben-Gurion University of the Negev**
Additional affiliation

2022–25 **Lecturer, Department of Industrial Engineering and Management, Ben-Gurion University of the Negev**
Tenure-track rank; corresponds to U.S. Assistant Professor

2021–22 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow, School of Mathematical Sciences, Tel Aviv University**
Hosts: Prof. Eilon Solan and Prof. Ehud Lehrer

2020–21 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Center of Mathematical Sciences and Applications, Harvard University**
Host: Prof. Scott Duke Kominers

2019–20 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow and Fulbright Scholar, Management Science and Engineering, Stanford University**
Host: Prof. Itai Ashlagi

2018 **Ph.D. Research Intern, Social Technologies Lab, Cornell Tech**
Host: Prof. Mor Naaman

EDUCATION

2019 **Ph.D., Industrial Engineering and Management, Technion – Israel Institute of Technology**
Dissertation: *Social Learning in Adaptive Environments*
Advisors: Prof. Rann Smorodinsky and Prof. Itai Arieli

2015 **M.A. in Economics (research track, joint with Tel Aviv University), The Hebrew University of Jerusalem**
Thesis: *To Pool or Not to Pool? On Mining Competition and Transfer Fees in Bitcoin*
Advisor: Dr. Liad Blumrosen

2009 **B.A. in Economics and Business Administration, The Hebrew University of Jerusalem**
Magna cum laude

PUBLICATIONS

Refereed Journal Articles

2026 [7] The Gatekeeper Effect: The Implications of Pre-Screening, Self-Selection, and Bias for Hiring Processes
M. Koren
Management Science
vol. 72(1), pp. 426–441

2026 [6] The Multi-BMBY Mechanism: Proportionality-Preserving and Strategyproof Ownership Restructuring in Private Companies
G. Danino, **M. Koren**, O. Madmon
Journal of Economics & Management Strategy
vol. 35(1), pp. 50–58

2026 [5] Reimagining Israel's Food System: Balancing Mediterranean Diet Recommendations with National Food Security, Sovereignty and Resilience
E. Berkovich, S. Shapira, **M. Koren**, N. Talmon, D. Nitzan
Israel Journal of Health Policy Research
vol. 15(1), article 6

2024 [4] Information Aggregation in Large Collective Purchases
I. Arieli, **M. Koren**, R. Smorodinsky$^{\alpha}$
Economic Theory
vol. 78(1), pp. 295–345

2023 [3] Learning Approximately Optimal Contracts
A. Cohen, A. Deligkas, **M. Koren**$^{\alpha}$
Theoretical Computer Science
vol. 980, 114219. Invited extended version of the SAGT 2022 paper

2022 [2] The Implication of Pricing on Social Learning
I. Arieli, **M. Koren**, R. Smorodinsky$^{\alpha}$
Theoretical Economics
vol. 17(4), pp. 1761–1802

2022 [1] The Welfare Costs of Informationally Efficient Prices
M. Koren, M. Mueller-Frank$^{\alpha}$
Games and Economic Behavior
vol. 131, pp. 186–196

Refereed Conference Proceedings

2025 [11] Strategic Behavior in Crowdfunding: Insights from a Large-Scale Online Experiment
D. Amir[†], B. Hoter[†], **M. Koren**
Web and Internet Economics (WINE 2025)
New Brunswick, NJ. Acceptance rate 29.8%

2025 [10] Enhancing Food Security with Blockchain: Developing a Web3 Application to Strengthen National Food System Resilience
B. Hoter[†], **M. Koren**, D. Nitzan, S. Shapira, N. Talmon[α]
IEEE Symposium on Computers and Communications (ISCC 2025)
Bologna, Italy. Acceptance rate 36.6%

2025 [9] Can (A)I Change Your Mind?
M. Havin, T. Wharton Kleinman, **M. Koren**, A. Goldstein, Y. Dover
Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2025)
San Francisco, CA

2024 [8] Classification Under Strategic Self-Selection
G. Horowitz, Y. Sommer, **M. Koren**, N. Rosenfeld
Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2024)
Vienna, Austria. Acceptance rate 27.5%

2022 [7] Learning Approximately Optimal Contracts
A. Cohen, A. Deligkas, **M. Koren**[α]
Algorithmic Game Theory: 15th International Symposium (SAGT 2022)
Colchester, UK. Acceptance rate 41%

2021 [6] Counterbalancing Learning and Strategic Incentives in Allocation Markets
J. Kang, **M. Koren**, F. Monachou, I. Ashlagi
Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 34 (NeurIPS 2021)
Acceptance rate 26%

2020 [5] Sequential Fundraising and Social Insurance
A. Ban, **M. Koren**[α]
Proceedings of the 21st ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC '20)
Acceptance rate 20%

2020 [4] How Partisan Crowds Affect News Evaluation
M. Jakesch, **M. Koren**, A. Evtushenko, M. Naaman
Conference for Truth and Trust Online (TTO 2020)
Acceptance rate 39%

2019 [3] The Implication of Pricing on Social Learning
I. Arieli, **M. Koren**, R. Smorodinsky[α]
Proceedings of the 20th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC '19)
Phoenix, AZ. Acceptance rate 27.7%

2018 [2] The One-Shot Crowdfunding Game
I. Arieli, **M. Koren**, R. Smorodinsky[α]
Proceedings of the 19th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC '18)
Ithaca, NY. Acceptance rate 26%

2017 [1] The Crowdfunding Game
I. Arieli, **M. Koren**, R. Smorodinsky$^{\alpha}$
Web and Internet Economics (WINE 2017)
Bangalore, India. Acceptance rate 38%

Submitted for Publication

2026 [10] Sequential Fundraising and Mutual Insurance
A. Ban, **M. Koren**$^{\alpha}$
Revise and resubmit, *Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics*. Extends the EC '20 paper

2026 [9] Counterbalancing Learning and Strategic Incentives in Allocation Markets
J. Kang, **M. Koren**, F. Monachou, I. Ashlagi
Revise and resubmit (major revision), *Manufacturing & Service Operations Management*. Extends the NeurIPS 2021 paper

2026 [8] Build the Player: Teaching Game Theory by Designing Strategic Agents
M. Koren
Revise and resubmit (major revision), *INFORMS Transactions on Education*

2026 [7] Fairness-Constrained Actor–Critic for Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning
O. Sheetrit†, **M. Koren**, S. Shperberg
Submitted, AAAI

2026 [6] Information Aggregation and Strategic Urgency in Common Value Markets: Experiment and Analysis
Y. Peled†, **M. Koren**
Submitted, AAMAS 2027

2026 [5] Batch Offering Under Uncertainty: A Common Value Stopping Game Model for Organ Allocation
M. Koren, V. Bar Nir, Y. Cornfeld
Submitted, AAMAS 2027. Presented at ORSIS 2026

2026 [4] Saying, Planning, Doing: Grounding Mechanisms and Stated-Intent Consistency of LLM Agents in Settlers of Catan
M. Koren, S. Levin†
Submitted, AAMAS 2027

2026 [3] Goldstein Equilibrium for Two-Player Lipschitz Games: Theory and Certification
M. Koren, A. Taitler
Submitted, AAMAS 2027

2026 [2] On the Complexity and the Price of Fairness in Repetitive Scheduling Problems
D. Hermelin, **M. Koren**, M. L. Pinedo, D. Shabtay$^{\alpha}$
Submitted, *Journal of Scheduling*

2026 [1] The KAS250 Kidney Offer Acceptance Decline: Behavior or Mechanism? Adjudicating the Post-Reform Fall in Offer Acceptance and Its Operational Cost in Donation After Circulatory Death
S. Tzidkolov†, **M. Koren**
Submitted, *American Journal of Transplantation*

Working Papers and Preprints

2026 [1] Theorist Toolbox: Tools for Agent-Based LLM-Assisted Economic Theory Research
M. Koren
arXiv:2606.22337

Other Publications

2021 The Risks and Rewards of Digital Currencies
N. Gaselevich, H. Jabotinsky, **M. Koren**
Globes
Op-ed (Hebrew; translated title), August 8, 2021

2019 The Role of Source, Headline and Expressive Responding in Political News Evaluation
M. Jakesch, **M. Koren**, A. Evtushenko, M. Naaman
Computation + Journalism Symposium

2019 Incentivizing the Dynamic Workforce: Learning Contracts in the Gig-Economy
A. Cohen, **M. Koren**, A. Deligkas
Workshop on Learning in the Presence of Strategic Behavior, EC '19

† student advisee at time of work α authors alphabetical

WORK IN PROGRESS

2026 Crowdfunding Games with Heterogeneous Contributors: Theory and Experiment, with D. Amir† and B. Hoter†

2026 A Graph-Based Mechanism for Assigning Displaced Individuals, with Y. Doron† and A. Kulik

2026 Placement Games with Threshold-Linear Congestion: A Graphical Potential-Game Approach to Decentralized Assignment, with S. Horowitz† and Y. Doron†

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2027–29 PI (BGU; with N. Rosenfeld, project coordinator), Ministry of Science and Technology, Call for Research Proposals in Artificial Intelligence 2026 (topic: safety in the use of generative AI), *Contractual Alignment for Delegated AI Agents*, NIS 500,000 total (US$142,857); NIS 270,000 share (US$77,143)

2025–26 PI, Israel Science Foundation, Personal Grant, *Pre-Filtering Mechanisms and Self-Selection: Theoretical Insights into the Gatekeeper's Role under Uncertainty*, NIS 380,000 (US$108,571)

2025–26 PI, Israel Science Foundation, Equipment Grant, NIS 67,500 (US$19,286)

2023–26 Head PI (with D. Nitzan, N. Talmon, S. Shapira), Ministry of Science and Technology, Security, Food and Food Tech Program, NIS 750,000 total (US$214,286); NIS 250,000 share (US$71,429)

2025 Co-PI (with I. Shurtz and N. Gershoni), Ben-Gurion University, BGU-CHER Grant, *Market Dynamics in Organ Procurement*, NIS 12,500 (US$3,571)

2025 Co-PI (with A. Taitler), Ben-Gurion University, Paul Ivanier Research Grant, *Adaptive Decentralized Two-Regions Perimeter Control*, US$7,500

2025 PI, Ben-Gurion University, Research Group "Culture, Society, and Technology" and Data Science Center Grant, *Experimental Investigation of Crowdfunding Mechanisms*, NIS 12,000 (US$3,429)

2024 PI, Israel Data Science Initiative (IDSI), Projects for Social Good, NIS 20,000 (US$5,714)

2021 Fellow, Israel Science Foundation, Shamir Fellowship for Returning Scientists, *Market Design Under Uncertainty*, NIS 280,000 (US$80,000)

2020 Fellow, Harvard University (CMSA), Postdoctoral Fellowship in Financial Economics, US$90,000

2019 Fellow, USIEF, Fulbright Post-doctoral Scholar Award, US$47,500

2019 Fellow, Stanford University (Management Science and Engineering), Postdoctoral Stipend, US$30,000

HONORS AND AWARDS

2026 Innovative Lecturer Award, Unit for the Advancement of Teaching and Learning Quality, Ben-Gurion University of the Negev, for the redesign of *Game Theory and Agentic Design*

2018 Keiden Prize for Graduate Students, Faculty of Industrial Engineering and Management, Technion

2017 Harold and Inge Marcus Endowment Ph.D. Fellowship, Technion/PSU IE Partnership

2016 Bernard M. Gordon Center for Systems Engineering Fellowship, Technion

2015–19 Ph.D. Stipend, Technion

INVITED TALKS AND SEMINARS

2026 INFORMS Annual Meeting, San Francisco (invited speaker); a16z Research Department (virtual); University of York, Economics; Bar-Ilan University, Economics (two seminars); Ben-Gurion University, Economics

2025 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta (invited speaker)

2024 TUM School of Social Sciences and Technology, Munich; Tel Aviv University, Operations Management Seminar

2023 Bar-Ilan University, Game Theory Seminar

2022 Technion, Game Theory Seminar; The Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Economics

2021 Harvard CMSA Big Data Conference (keynote); Marketplace Innovation Workshop; Ariel University; Ben-Gurion University, Industrial Engineering and Management

2020	Ben-Gurion University, Economics
2018	Tel Aviv University, Coller School of Management, Strategy Group Seminar
2015–16	Bar-Ilan University, Economics; Bar-Ilan University, Game Theory Seminar

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026	ORSIS Annual Meeting (Technion); Mid-Chain 2026 (BGU)
2025	WINE (New Brunswick); Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory; Israeli Game Theory Day (HUJI); ORSIS Annual Meeting; IEEE ISCC (Bologna); CogSci (San Francisco)
2024	ICML (Vienna); ORSIS Annual Meeting (BGU); Israeli Industrial Engineering Day (BGU)
2023	ORSIS Annual Meeting
2022	Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory; SAGT (Colchester)
2021	NeurIPS (virtual); 6th World Congress of the Game Theory Society (virtual)
2019	EC (Phoenix); EC Workshop on Learning in the Presence of Strategic Behavior; Israeli Chapter of the Game Theory Society (TAU); Early Career Researcher Day (Haifa)
2017–18	EC (Ithaca); WINE (Bangalore); Lisbon Meetings in Game Theory and Applications
2016	5th World Congress of the Game Theory Society (Maastricht)

ADVISING

Ph.D.	Yuval Peled (2026–), strategic decision-making under competition in common-value markets
M.Sc.	Yuval Doron (2024–; with A. Kulik); Yarden Weiss, Sharona Isacov, Daniel Azoulay and Ron Halevi (all 2026–)
Completed	Oriya Sheetrit (M.Sc. 2026; with S. Shperberg), Din Amir (M.Sc. 2026), Gal Ram (M.Sc. 2026; with A. Taitler), Ohad Kiperman (M.Sc. 2026; now Data Scientist, Zefr), Bar Hoter (M.Sc. 2026; with N. Talmon; now Data Analyst, Vi), Yuval Peled (M.Sc. 2025; continued to Ph.D.)
Honors	Advisees: Dean's Honors 2026 (O. Sheetrit, O. Kiperman, G. Ram); Rector's Honors 2026 (Y. Doron); KKL Fellowship for Sustainability and Climate Change 2025 (B. Hoter)

TEACHING

2026–	Game Theory and Agentic Design (undergraduate elective), Ben-Gurion University
2026–	Introduction to Decision Theory (undergraduate core), Ben-Gurion University

2024–26	Introduction to Research in IE&M for honors students (undergraduate elective), Ben-Gurion University
2022–	Estimation and Hypothesis Testing (undergraduate core), Ben-Gurion University
2022–	Game Theory (graduate elective), Ben-Gurion University
2022–25	Game Theory (undergraduate elective), Ben-Gurion University

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Community	Core contributor (one of seven), **MathEconLib** (2026–): a Lean 4 library of machine-checked foundations for economics spanning microeconomic theory, macroeconomic theory and econometrics, developed with the support of Axiom Math; first released component *auctionlib* (auction theory and posted pricing)
Organizing	• Cluster Co-Chair, Auctions and Market Design, INFORMS Annual Meeting 2026, San Francisco • Co-Founder and Organizing Committee, Mid-Chain 2026 (Conference on Blockchain and Decentralized Economics), BGU • Organizing Committee, Data Science, Operations and Analytics (Mind-IL 2026) • Organizing Committee, ORSIS Annual Meeting 2024
Committees	Program committee: AAMAS (2027); ACM EC (2020, 2024, 2025); The Web Conference (2026); ITCS (2026); IJCAI (2024); WINE (2021, 2024); SAGT (2023–2025); NeurIPS (2021) and its Strategic ML Workshop (2021); EC Workshop on Learning in the Presence of Strategic Behavior (2019)
Refereeing	*Review of Economic Studies*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Journal of Economic Theory*, *Management Science*, *Theoretical Economics*, *Theory and Decision*, *International Journal of Game Theory*, *Artificial Intelligence*, *European Journal of Operational Research*, *Journal of Artificial Intelligence Research*
Memberships	Econometric Society; Game Theory Society; American Economic Association; ACM; INFORMS; Mechanism Design for Social Good; Israeli Economics Society; ORSIS

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

2024–26	Founder and head, “Hetz” young-researchers track for honors undergraduates, Industrial Engineering and Management, BGU
2023–	Coordinator of economics and business courses, Industrial Engineering and Management, BGU
2022–	Faculty in charge of “Meitar” and “Keshet” accelerated M.Sc. programs for honors students, BGU
2022–	Advisor of the fourth-year undergraduate class, Industrial Engineering and Management, BGU

OTHER

Industry	Senior Data Scientist, Taboola, Tel Aviv (2013–2015)
Software	Theorist Toolbox: open-source toolkit for verified LLM-assisted economic theory (github.com/morankor/theorist-toolbox, MIT; 75 stars); companion paper arXiv:2606.22337
Public	Founding member, "Habaita" forum, Samuel Neaman Institute (2024–): aid and placement of citizens displaced from northern Israel

REFERENCES

Prof. Rann Smorodinsky
Professor, Faculty of Data and Decision Sciences
Technion – Israel Institute of Technology
rann@technion.ac.il

Prof. Itai Arieli
Associate Professor, Department of Economics
University of Toronto
itai.arieli@utoronto.ca

Prof. Itai Ashlagi
Professor, Management Science and Engineering
Stanford University
iashlagi@stanford.edu

Prof. Scott Duke Kominers
Professor
Harvard Business School
skominers@hbs.edu